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A

GRAMMAR

OF THE

ARABIC LANGUAGE,

INTENDED CHIEFLY FOR THE

ARABIC STUDENTS OF THE CALCUTTA UNIVERSITY;

TO WHICH IS APPENDED

AN ESSAY ON THE ARABIC LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE.

BY

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PREFACE.

On my being elected in 1865 to the chair of Professor of Arabic in the Húgli College, I found the want of an Arabic elementary grammar was greatly felt by the Arabic students of the Calcutta University. Acting therefore under the advice of Mr. Thwaytes, Principal of the College, I determined to compile such a grammar, as I thought was needed, in the U'rdú language and modelled on the concise and simple plan of European grammars. That little work, along with my Arabic Primer and First and Second Readers, has been extensively used and, I believe, has greatly facilitated the acquirement of Arabic in this country, especially to the Undergraduates of the Calcutta University. Encouraged by the ...bs of the above compilation, I have been induced ...tablish an Arabic Grammar in English, the lan... in which the University Examinations are con...Al.

...e few Arabic Grammars in English published ...s country, such as Lumsden's Arabic Grammar, ...he English translations of the Miat Amil and ...yatunnahw besides being out of print, are incom... and recondite, being entirely based on the native ... Among the Anglo-Arabic grammars which ...e appeared in Europe and are available in this ...ntry, are those by Forbes and Wright. The former

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says : "this composition which approaches nearer to the epic poem than any in the language, is one of the latest productions of the great ages of Arabian literature. Sir. W. Jones bears witness to the genius of the author.....In this work rhyme and assonance abound with luxuriance, that almost oppresses the reader, and the employment of such a style by an author of originality and genius, who had before him the greatest productions of his predecessors, shows how deeply rooted in the nature of the people was the sentiment for unmetrical cadence."

Among the *Qasas* or the works of fiction are the famous Alf Laila or the Arabian Nights' Entertainments and the story of Shaddád bin 'Antara. The latter is in a classical style, full of elegance and beauty. It contains fine poetical pieces quoted at proper places. The former is composed in a very homely style, and the language is colloquial and flowing. It has also fine happy poetical pieces of different authors quoted in proper places, which add much to the beauty, and give pleasure to the reader. Some hold that the Arabian Nights has been composed under the auspices of the Caliphs of Bagdad, of the social refinement and the splendour of whose courts it gives such lively pictures as are exhibited in many of its tales. But according to some it is a subsequent production, because it contains many stories of later period.

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